Ismail Ali Haji | Technical Lead and Cyber Security Engineer

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A. Personal Details

Date of Birth: 08 July 2000

Gender: Male

Nationality: Tanzania

Marital Status: Single

Disability Status: No Disability

Languages: English, Kiswahili

B. Personal Profile

Ismail Haji is a Technical Lead at EvMak Tanzania and a Cybersecurity and Digital Forensic professional with over 3 years of experience in software engineering, financial technology, cybersecurity and web development. He leads the engineering of production payment systems, including the EvPay payment gateway, mobile money and core banking integrations, a traffic gate billing system, and middleware that forwards vehicle device data to LATRA. He holds a Bachelor's degree in Cyber Security and Digital Forensic Engineering from the University of Dodoma and has a proven track record in building secure systems, leading technical teams, conducting forensic investigations and managing production infrastructure. He is proactive, detail-oriented, and thrives in team environments while also capable of working independently.

C. Academic Qualifications

Bachelor in Cyber Security and Digital Forensic Engineering — **Tanzania**
University of Dodoma (UDOM), Completed — *2021/10–2025/07*

Advanced Certificate of Secondary Education Examination (ACSEE) — **Tanzania**
Zanzibar Commercial Secondary School, Completed — *2019/05–2021/05*

Certificate of Secondary Education Examination (CSEE) — **Tanzania**
Zanzibar Commercial Secondary School, Completed — *2014/01–2018/11*

D. Professional Qualifications

Cybersecurity Essentials — **Tanzania**
Laura Quintana, Online — *2022/04–2022/05*

Computer Certificate — **Tanzania**
Hamad Omar, Physical — *2019/06–2021/07*

E. Core Competencies

- Technical leadership and engineering team management
- Payment gateway, mobile money and banking integration
- Backend development and API design (REST, SOAP, webhooks)
- DevOps, containerised deployment and production support
- Telematics device integration and middleware
- Cybersecurity threat analysis and mitigation
- Digital forensic investigations
- Web development and system administration
- Software development and testing

- Team collaboration and training

F. Attributes

- Technical leadership and team coordination
- Excellent teamwork and collaboration
- Self-motivated and proactive
- Strong analytical and problem-solving skills
- Effective communication skills
- Detail-oriented and organized

G. Work Experience

Company: EvMak Tanzania **Dar es Salaam, Tanzania**
Position: Technical Lead *2025/08–Present*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Lead the engineering team: set technical direction, assign and review work, and mentor developers on code quality and security.
- Architect and maintain the EvPay payment gateway for collections and disbursements (C2B, B2C, W2A).
- Lead mobile money and payment integrations with Vodacom M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Mixx by Yas (Tigo), HaloPesa, Selcom and CyberSource.
- Designed and delivered a traffic gate billing system covering tariff calculation, mobile money payment, receipts and gate-pass validation.
- Worked with InnovaTECH Solutions Tanzania Limited, a provider of secure telematics, total fleet management, fuel intelligence and asset control for transport, logistics, agriculture, mining, finance and oil and gas, on the LATRA integration and traffic gate billing system.
- Built and managed the middleware that collects data from tracking devices installed in vehicles and forwards it securely to LATRA (Land Transport Regulatory Authority).
- Managed device traffic through the same middleware for the traffic gate billing system, keeping data flow from gate and vehicle devices reliable.
- Integrate Apache Fineract/Mifos core banking for account operations, payments and settlement.
- Build callback processing, transaction status checks, retries and daily reconciliation across all payment providers.
- Manage production on Linux with Docker, Podman, Traefik and Cloudflare, including releases, rollbacks and incident response.

Company: E-Government Authority (EGA) **Dodoma, Tanzania**
Position: Software Engineer *2024/10–2025/07*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Develop and maintain secure software applications for research centres using different web technologies.
- Conduct code reviews and ensure compliance with cybersecurity standards.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to design and implement software solutions.
- Perform system testing and debugging to ensure functionality and security.

Company: Shehena E-Commerce **Dodoma, Tanzania**
Position: Web eCommerce Technician *2023/12–2024/02*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Configured and maintained WordPress eCommerce websites using WooCommerce for seamless functionality and optimal user experience.
- Managed product listings, ensuring accurate pricing, inventory, and categorization for effective online store operations.
- Set up and managed shipping settings, tax calculations, and price calculation to meet business and customer needs.

- Performed regular backups and updates to WordPress core, themes, and plugins to ensure system reliability and compliance.

Company: Tanzania Police Headquarters **Dar es Salaam, Tanzania**
Position: Cyber Security and Forensic Expert *2023/07–2023/10*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Conducted digital forensic investigations on cybercrime cases using tools like MOBILedit, Cellebrite, FTK Imager and Physical Analyzer.
- Prepared detailed reports on forensic findings and presented them to supervisors.
- Performed analysis on mobile devices and computers to find evidence.

Company: Zanzibar Commercial Secondary School **Zanzibar, Tanzania**
Position: Web Master *2019/04–2023/04*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Designed and maintained the school's website, ensuring accessibility and security using WordPress.
- Managed content updates and ensured compliance with web standards.
- Provided technical support for web-related issues.
- Trained O-level and A-level students in web development and other programming languages in Computer Studies.
- Prepared examinations for students.

Company: The University of Dodoma **Dodoma, Tanzania**
Position: Industrial Training *2022/07–2022/09*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Assisted in configuring secure servers and the mail server to ensure secure delivery of email.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and recommended mitigation strategies.
- Set up network devices, CCTV cameras and VoIP calls using PBX.

Company: Zanzibar Environmental Club **Zanzibar, Tanzania**
Position: ICT Officer *2020/01–2022/01*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Developed and maintained the organization website and system using HTML, CSS and a PHP framework.
- Managed and updated social media platforms (e.g., Instagram, Facebook).
- Designed posters and content for environmental campaigns and events using Adobe Photoshop and Canva.
- Collaborated with the club's leadership to develop digital campaigns promoting environmental conservation, waste management, and sustainability.

Company: Zanzibar Commercial Secondary School **Zanzibar, Tanzania**
Position: Student President Leader *2020/01–2021/01*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Represented the student body in meetings with school administration, teachers, and external stakeholders.
- Organized and led school-wide events, including academic competitions, cultural festivals, and environmental awareness campaigns.
- Coordinated with student leaders and clubs to ensure effective communication and collaboration on school initiatives.
- Delivered speeches and presentations during assemblies and school events.
- Ensured compliance with school policies, promoting a safe and respectful environment for all students.

Company: Tawakal Hospital **Zanzibar, Tanzania**
Position: Data Entry *2018/07–2018/08*
Duties and Responsibilities

- Entered and managed patient data in hospital systems with high accuracy.
- Ensured data confidentiality and compliance with privacy regulations.

- Supported administrative staff in maintaining accurate records.

H. Skills

- **FinTech & Payments**: Payment Gateways, Mobile Money APIs (C2B, B2C, W2A), TANQR, Selcom, CyberSource, Reconciliation, Settlement
- **Banking & Billing Systems**: Apache Fineract / Mifos, Billing and Tariff Systems
- **Telematics & Middleware**: Vehicle Device Data Collection, LATRA Data Integration, Device Traffic Management, Middleware Design
- **DevOps & Infrastructure**: Linux, Docker, Podman, Traefik, Cloudflare, Git, GitLab CI/CD
- **API & Security**: REST, SOAP, Webhooks, OAuth 2.0, Keycloak, Penetration Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Digital Forensic Analysis
- **Software Development**: Backend Development, Blockchain App Development, Full Stack Web Application Development
- **Programming Languages**: PHP, JavaScript (Node.js), Python, Java, C++, SQL
- **Frameworks**: Laravel, Vue 3, Django, Angular, Spring Boot, Solidity
- **Web Technologies**: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS
- **Databases**: MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, Database Management

I. Communication Ability

Language	Reading	Writing	Speaking	Understanding
English	Excellent	Excellent	Very Good	Very Good
Swahili	Excellent	Excellent	Excellent	Excellent

J. Project Portfolio

Current Projects – EvMak Tanzania

EvPay Payment Gateway *2025/08–Present*
Payment gateway for collections and disbursements, letting merchants accept M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Mixx by Yas, HaloPesa and card payments through one integration.

LATRA Integration *2025/08–Present*
Middleware integration that collects data from tracking devices installed in vehicles and forwards it to the Land Transport Regulatory Authority (LATRA), delivered with InnovaTECH Solutions Tanzania Limited.

Traffic Gate Billing System *2025/08–Present*
Billing system that calculates gate tariffs, takes mobile money payments, issues receipts and validates gate passes, with daily reconciliation reports. Delivered with InnovaTECH Solutions Tanzania Limited, with middleware managing traffic from gate and telematics devices.

TANQR Merchant Payments *2025/08–Present*
Integration of Tanzania's national QR payments for merchants, including callback handling and transaction tracking.

Core Banking Integration (Apache Fineract / Mifos) *2025/08–Present*
Integration with core banking for account operations, payments and settlement.

Payment Callback & Monitoring Service *2025/08–Present*
Central service that receives payment provider callbacks, retries failures and tracks transaction status.

Personal and Academic Projects

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/credcheck.git *2025/01–2025/06*
AI Image Detection System: Developed an AI-powered image detection system using Python and machine learning frameworks, enabling accurate image detection.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/votechain.git *2025/06–2025/07*
Built a secure, transparent voting system using Solidity and Ethereum blockchain, ensuring tamper-proof election processes.

gitlab/epson-bridge *2024/10–2025/04*
Created a decentralized bridge for exchanging Tanzanian Shillings (TZS) to Bitcoin and vice versa using Solidity, APIs and smart contracts.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/LOGIN-AUTHENTICATION.git *2024/06–2024/07*
Secure Login Authentication: Developed a robust login authentication system using React JS, Spring Boot, and MySQL.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/eRail.git *2024/05–2024/06*
eRailway: Web-based train ticket booking system with a focus on security and user-friendly design.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/Student-Admission-System-Balockchainbased-.git *2023/12–2024/02*
Student Management System: Blockchain-based student admission system.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/-Zanzibar-Evironmental-Club.git *2024/02–2024/03*
Zanzibar Environmental Club: Platform for environmental organization news and member voting.

https://github.com/ismailhaji01/AFIS.git *2021/11–2022/06*
AFIS: System for recording victim data and fingerprint collection at crime scenes.

http://www.zanauthetictours.ac.tz/ *2021/02–2023/04*
Zanauthentic Travel: Tourism website.

https://misalitours.com/ *2022/01–2023/04*
Misali Tours: Tourism website and admin panel built with PHP and phpMyAdmin.

K. Training and Workshops

Deloitte
Database Management Training *2026/02/21–2026/03/17*

PDS **Tanzania**
Introduction to Microfinance, Training on starting a small business as an entrepreneur. *2021/09–2021/09*

World Bank **Tanzania**
World Bank Program, Training in science, computing, and research methodologies. *2016/04–2016/05*

L. Referees

Mr. Wilbard G. Masue
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Mr. Issac Mahenge
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Mr. Ona Kowero
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